

VOL.
1

FIRST
EDITION

VALOR
COMICS

FIRE
MELTS.

ICE
OBEYS.

SHE
RULES.

ANIEL

EMBER & FROST

THE FORGE QUEEN

RATED T+

\$4.99 US

DIRECT EDITION
VALORCOMICS.COM



GRAGMIRE CRATER
63rd LAYER
SETTLEMENT 07

ANOTHER
SHIFT.
ANOTHER
DAY.

ASH NEVER
STOPS.

NEITHER DO
WE.

DOWN HERE,
THERE'S NO
SKY.

JUST ROCK,
FIRE, AND
DEBT.

THE CRATER
DOESN'T
FORGIVE.

IT ONLY
TAKES.

BUT WE
STEAL WHAT
WE CAN.

HOUR.
JOY.
MEANING.

BECAUSE
UP HERE...

THERE'S
NOTHING
LEFT TO
PRAY TO.

GRAGMIRE
灰の都
CITY OF ASH

THE FORGE
OF VYRAZA.

CARVED INTO BASALT.
FUELED BY THE PLANET'S
BLEEDING HEART.

IN THIS PLACE,
STONE REMEMBERS
WHAT METAL FORGETS.

SHE DOES NOT
COMMAND FIRE.

SHE REMEMBERS
IT'S NAME.

HOT ENOUGH
TO BEND STONE.
NOT HOT ENOUGH
TO BREAK WILL.

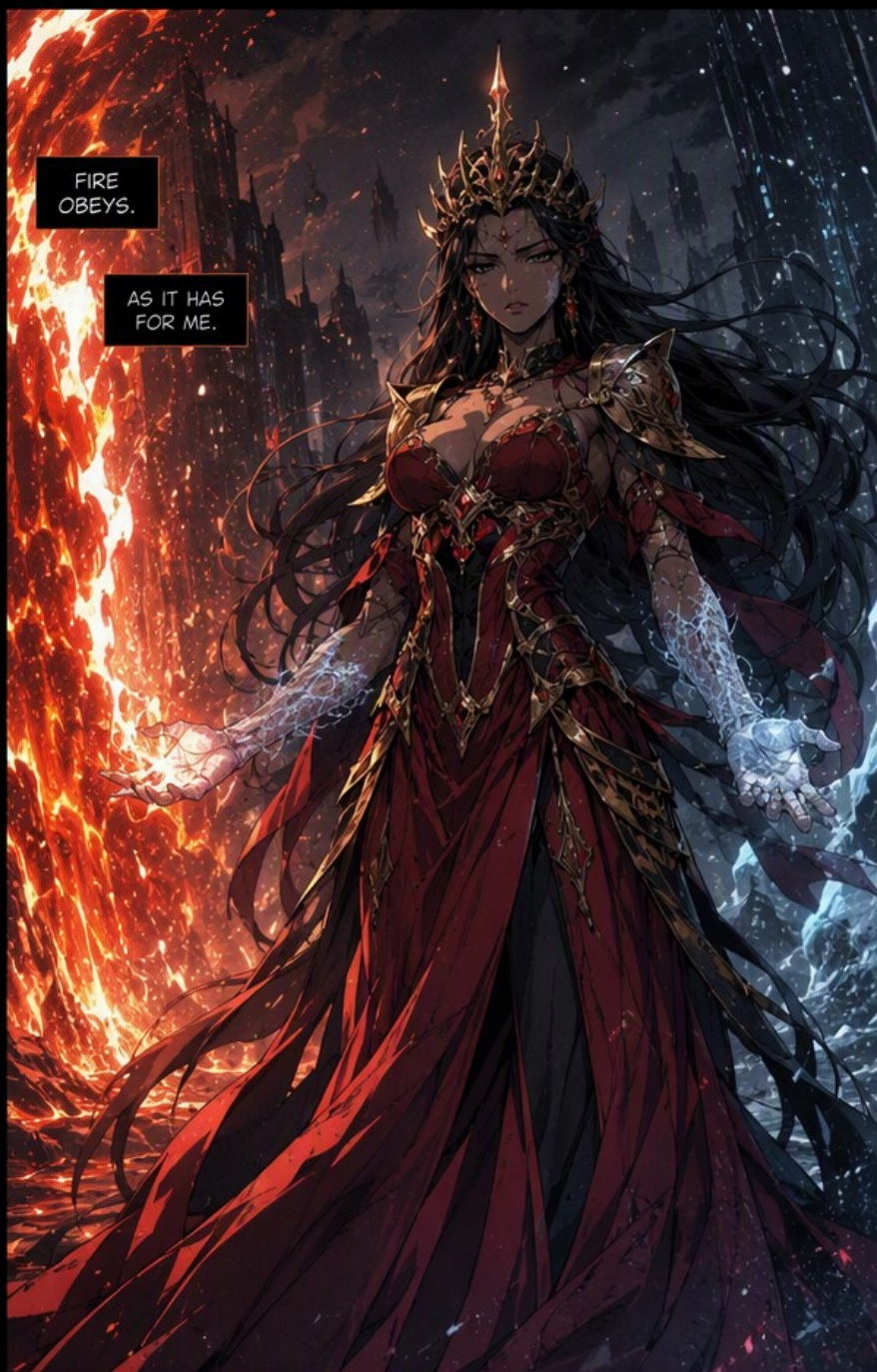
GOOD.

BRING ME
THE ALLOY.

THE ONE THAT
SINGS AGAINST
THE HAMMER.

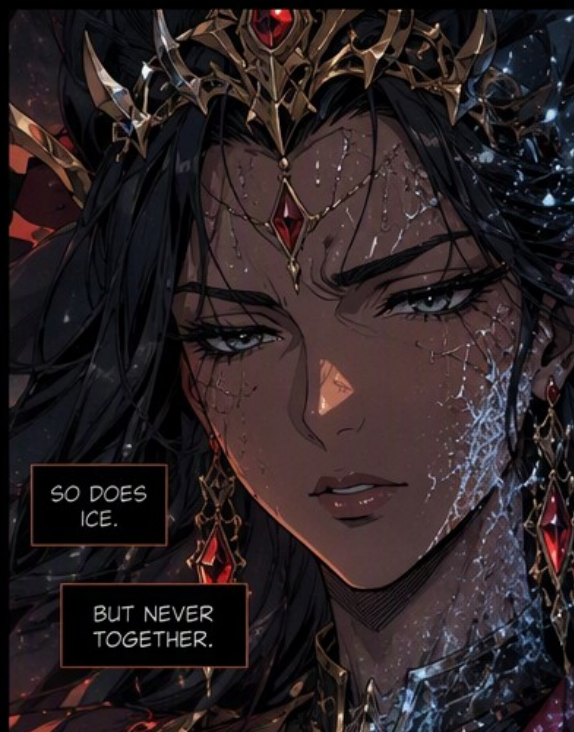
WE
SHALL TEMPER
MORE THAN
METAL TODAY.

WE SHALL
FORGE A
FUTURE.



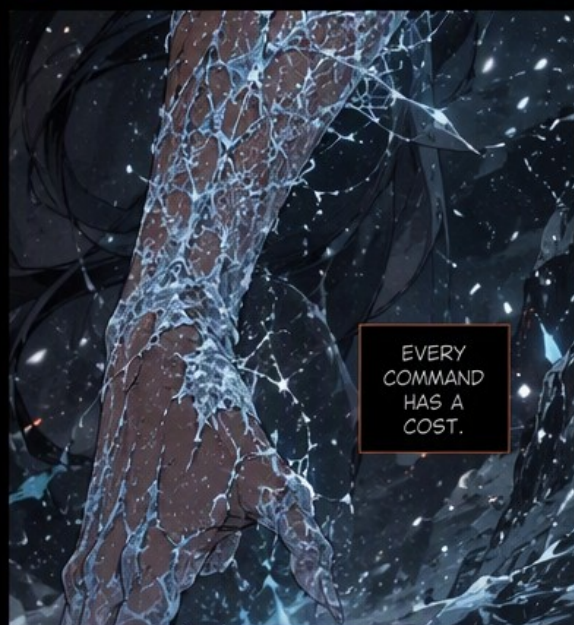
FIRE
OBEYS.

AS IT HAS
FOR ME.

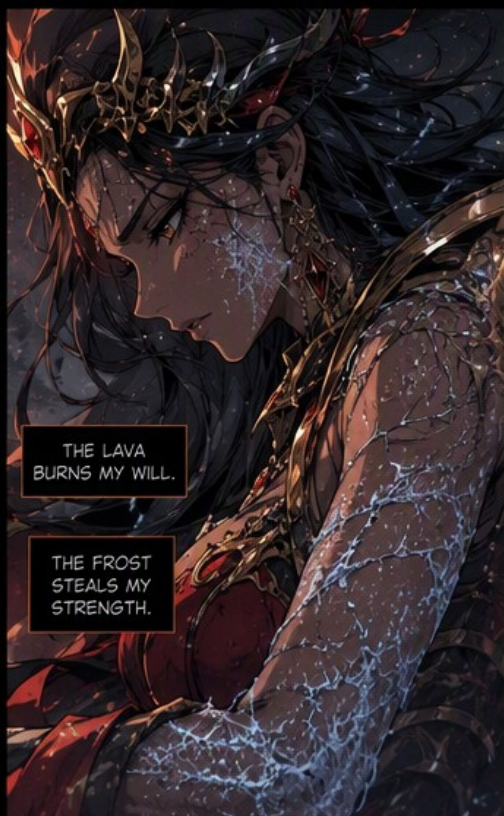


SO DOES
ICE.

BUT NEVER
TOGETHER.

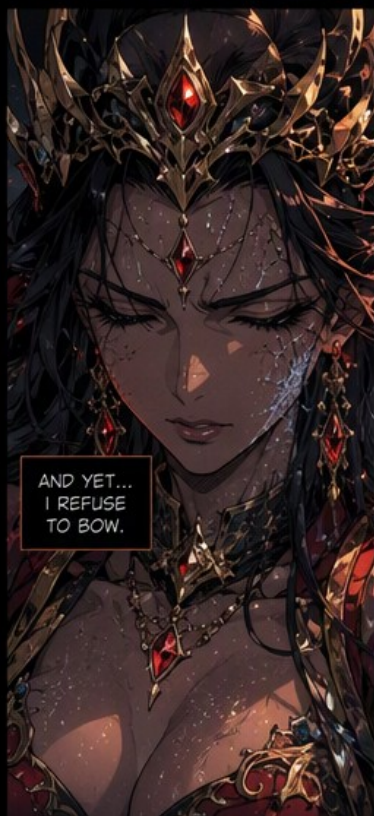


EVERY
COMMAND
HAS A
COST.



THE LAVA
BURNS MY WILL.

THE FROST
STEALS MY
STRENGTH.



AND YET...
I REFUSE
TO BOW.



I AM THE
BALANCE.

I AM ITS
BURDEN.

灰の岸边、
黒き入り江――

ここが私たちの
隠れ家だ。

鉄艦《グリーヴァ》

全長：58.7m 全幅：14.2m

排水量：1,580t

主動力：蒸気機関＋帆走補助

武装：前部衝角／回転砲塔×2／連装火砲×6

また
降ってきたな、
火山灰が。

ああ…
山の機嫌が
悪い。

だが、奴らよりは
ずっと静かだ。

この静けさが
いつまで続くか…

…見届けて
やるよ。

KESSELREICH

VOLCANO VILLAGE

THE ASH NEVER
STOPS FALLING.



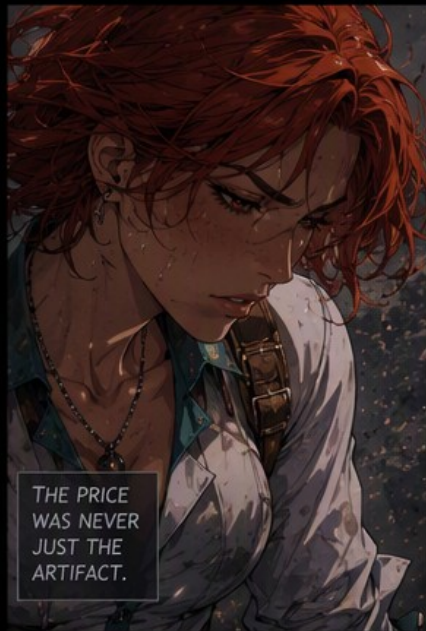
THE AIR BURNS.
MY LUNGS BURN.
BUT I KEEP CLIMBING.



ONE SWITCHBACK
AT A TIME.



THE PRICE
WAS NEVER
JUST THE
ARTIFACT.

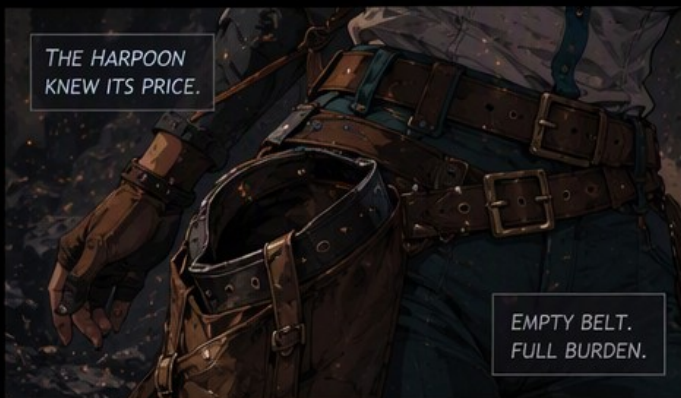


KESSELREICH
IS CLOSE.



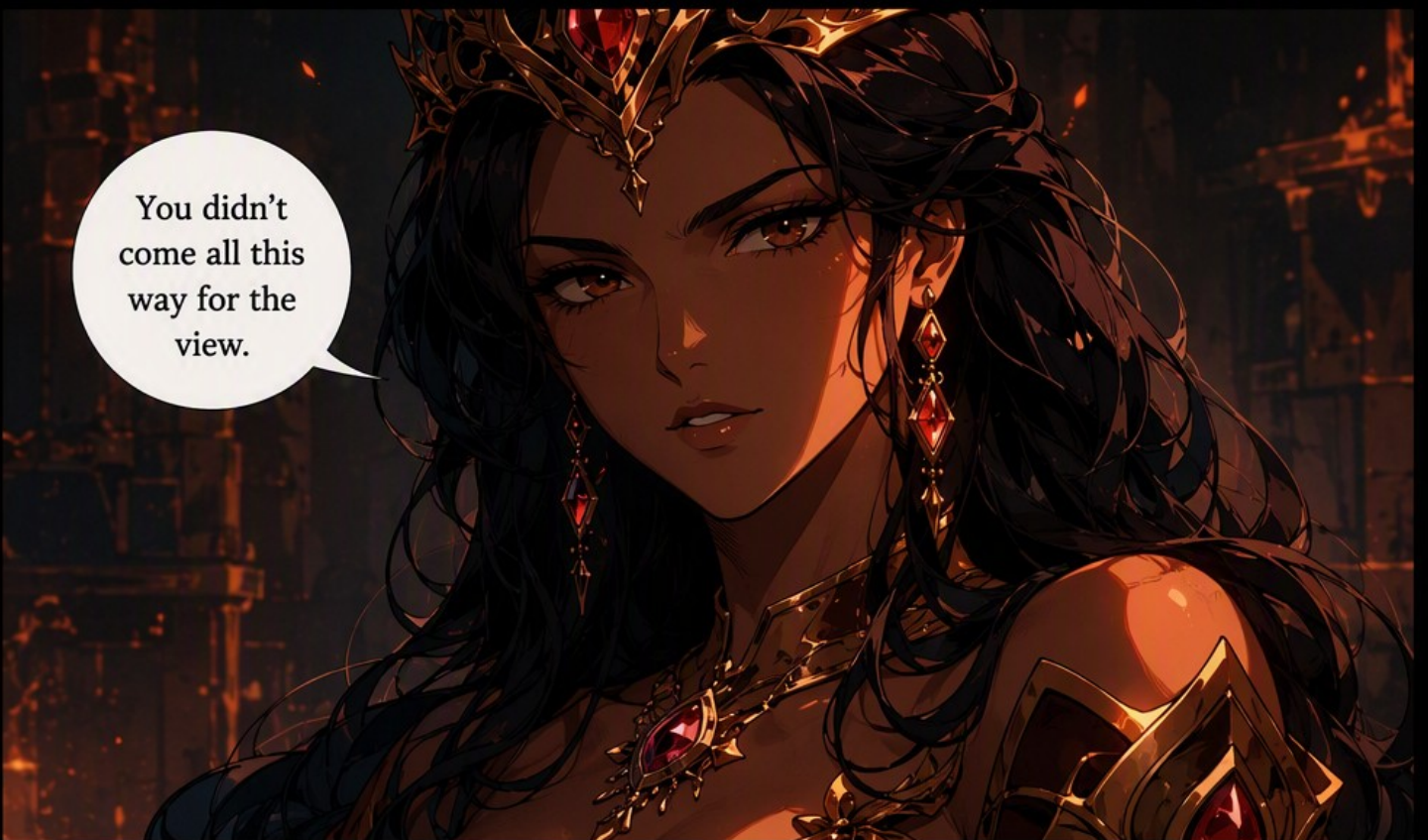
AND THE
TRUE HEIST
IS JUST
BEGINNING.

THE HARPOON
KNEW ITS PRICE.



EMPTY BELT.
FULL BURDEN.







FOUND
THIS JAMMED
INTO THE HULL.

HARPOON
HEAD. SHEARED
CLEAN OFF.



NOT BROKEN.

SHEARED.

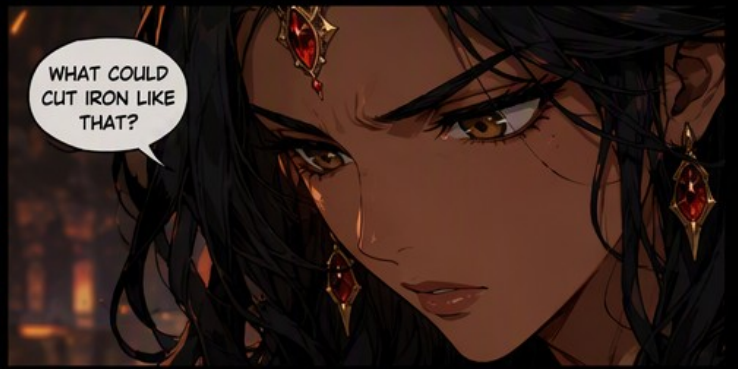
FLAT.
TOO PERFECT.



NO TOOLS
WOULD LEAVE
A CUT LIKE
THAT.

NO HEAT
EITHER.

NO MARKS.



WHAT COULD
CUT IRON LIKE
THAT?



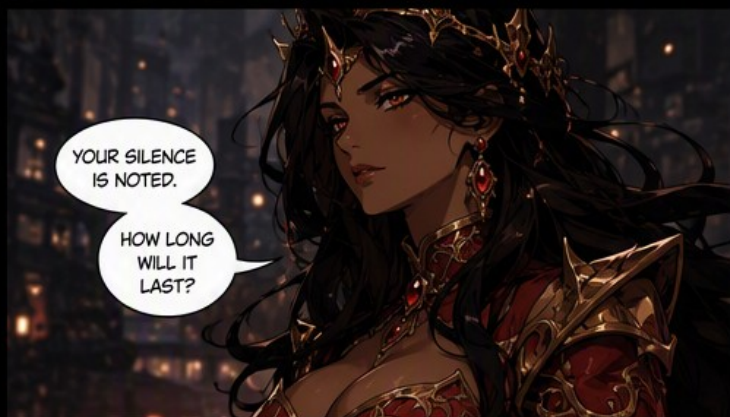
THAT IS
NOT POSSIBLE.



THE ASH NEVER STOPS
FALLING IN VERIDIAN'S
LOWER REACHES.

IT BLINDS. IT CHOKES.
IT REMINDS YOU WHO
YOU SERVE.

WE SERVE NOTHING.



YOUR SILENCE
IS NOTED.

HOW LONG
WILL IT
LAST?



LONG ENOUGH
TO GET WHAT
WE CAME FOR.



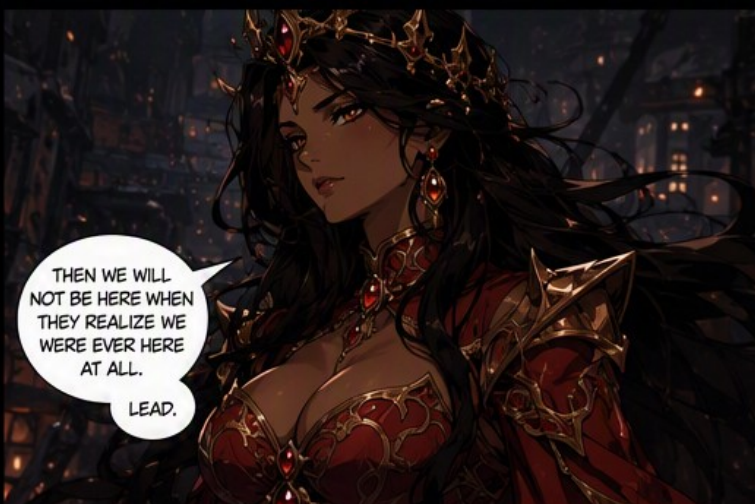
THE CHAINHOUSES
CLING TO THE ROCK
LIKE PARASITES.

BUILT BY THOSE
WHO FEAR FALLING
AS MUCH AS WE DO.



GUARDS
CHANGE SHIFT
IN THREE
MINUTES.

AFTER THAT,
FINDING OUR
WAY OUT GETS
MUCH HARDER.



THEN WE WILL
NOT BE HERE WHEN
THEY REALIZE WE
WERE EVER HERE
AT ALL.

LEAD.



A TEN-FOOT SECTION OF AN OTHERWISE GLOWING MAGMA VEIN SITS FLAT, GRAY, AND LITTERLY TEXTURELESS, RADIATING NEITHER HEAT NOR LIGHT.

IT'S LIKE IT WAS...UNMADE.



THE ASH ISN'T BURNING.

NOTHING HERE IS.



A DEAD VEIN.

THIS IS NO NATURAL PHENOMENON.



SOMETHING HAS BLED THE FIRE OUT.

OR SEALED IT AWAY.



EITHER WAY—SOMEONE DID THIS.

AND I INTEND TO FIND OUT WHO.



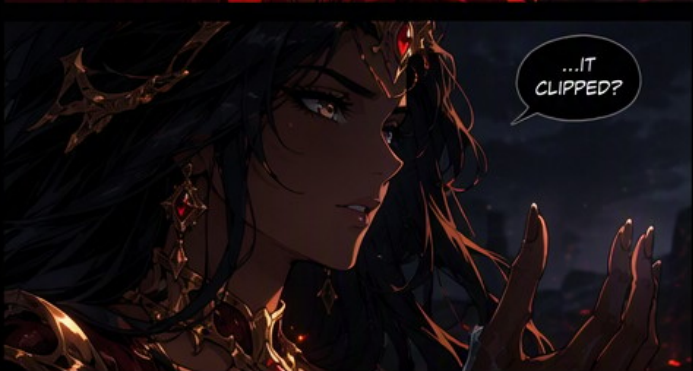
THE GREY
DEAD PATCH
SPREADS.

A CANCER
IN THE VEIN
OF MAGMA.

I WILL
BURN IT OUT.



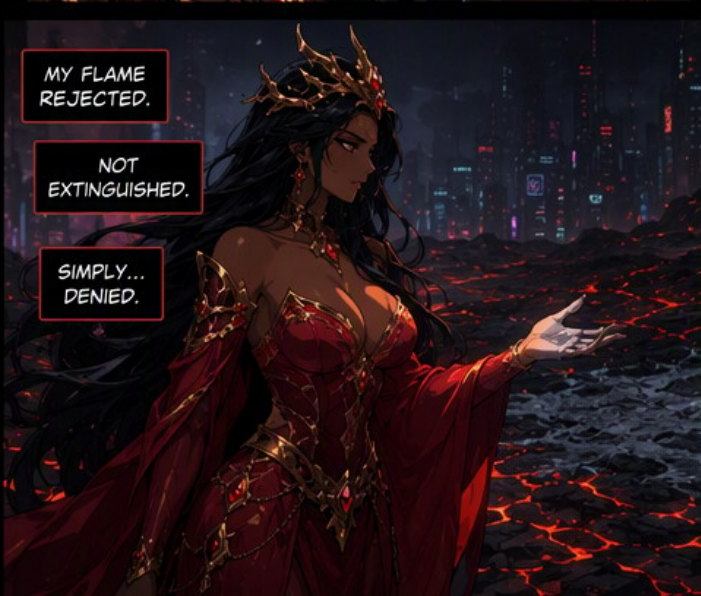
FWOOSH



...IT
CLIPPED?



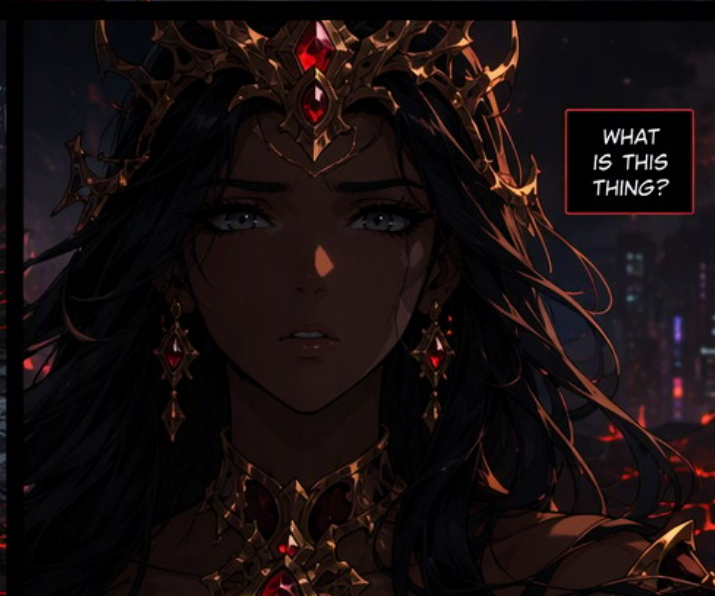
FROST.



MY FLAME
REJECTED.

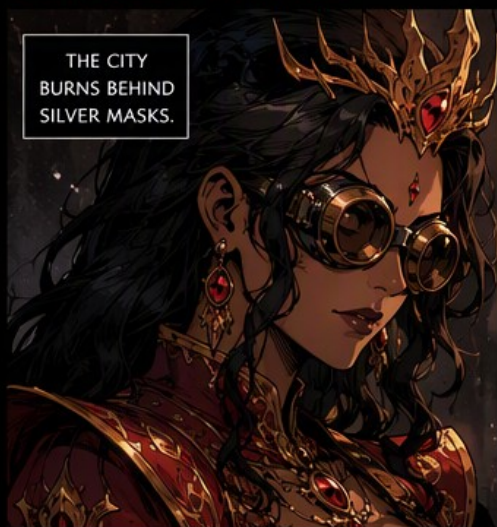
NOT
EXTINGUISHED.

SIMPLY...
DENIED.



WHAT
IS THIS
THING?





THE CITY
BURNS BEHIND
SILVER MASKS.



THEY THINK
I'VE RETREATED
TO MY THRONE.

LET THEM.



WHILE THEY
PREEN FOR POWER,



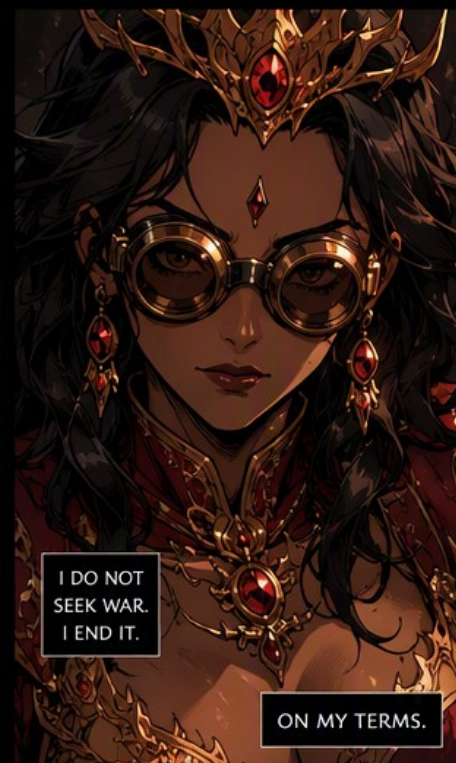
I PREPARE
FOR TRUTH.



THE
FLAME
DOESN'T
BEG.



IT
RECLAIMS.



I DO NOT
SEEK WAR.
I END IT.

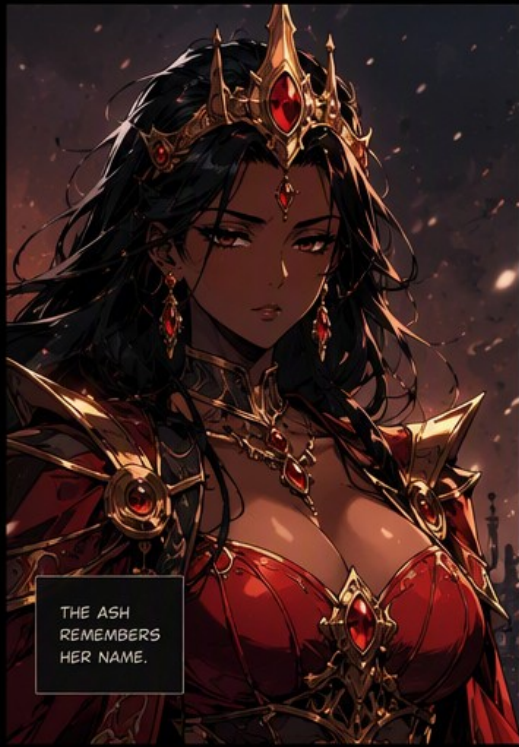
ON MY TERMS.

EMBER IS NOT A MEMORY.
EMBER IS A RECKONING.



THE FORGE
DOES NOT CALL
ITS SOVEREIGN
TO STAY.

IT CALLS.
SHE ANSWERS.
THEN SHE LEAVES.



THE ASH
REMEMBERS
HER NAME.



THE PEOPLE
REMEMBER
HER SILENCE.



NEITHER
EXPECTS HER
RETURN.



BUT THE FORGE
WILL CALL AGAIN.



THE CRATER'S WRATH
STILL BOILS BEHIND US...

BUT THE MOUNTAIN
WILL LET US GO—
IF WE EARN IT.



STEADY PACE.
DON'T RUSH
THE DESCENT.

LOOSE ROCK
WILL TAKE
YOUR ANKLE
BEFORE THE
LAVA DOES.



YOU SPEAK
FROM
EXPERIENCE.

GOOD.

I PREFER
SURVIVING
ADVISORS.



EACH TURN
TAKES US
FARTHER FROM
FIRE...

...AND CLOSER
TO WHAT LIES
BEYOND.



WHAT
WAITS FOR US
IN THE GREEN...
FRIEND OR
ENEMY?

BOTH.

AS IT HAS
ALWAYS
BEEN.

THE ASHEN
WASTES GIVE
WAY TO GREEN.

EVERY STEP
FURTHER FROM
THE FIRE...

...ANOTHER
TOWARD
SOMETHING
NEW.

